

GYM EQUIPMENT LAYOUT & CIRCULATION GUIDE

A practical guide to equipment clearances, circulation and zoning before the workout floor is finalised.

01 START WITH THE ZONES

- [] List every programme the floor must hold at peak: strength, cardio, classes, recovery, stretch.
- [] Give each programme a rectangle on plan before you place a single rack.
- [] Keep noisy, high-impact work away from the front desk and any quiet / recovery room.
- [] Put the most used zone where people land after changing — not at the far corner.
- [] Decide what can share a bay and what must never share (Olympic lifting vs a cycle class).

02 EQUIPMENT CLEARANCES

- [] Power rack: leave a loaded-bar path behind the lifter and a walk-past on at least one side.
- [] Bench pairs: keep enough gap that two users can rerack without touching.
- [] Selectorised machines: allow the stack to be loaded and the user to stand up without blocking the aisle.
- [] Dumbbell run: a clear lift-off strip in front of the rack, not into the circulation spine.
- [] Cardio banks: service access behind screens, and a way out that does not cross a squat bay.

03 BUILD A CIRCULATION SPINE

- [] Draw one primary spine from reception to the furthest training zone. Equipment does not sit on it.
- [] Keep it wide enough for two people to pass with a gym bag, including at peak hour.
- [] Do not let the spine die into a dead end of machines.
- [] Give a second service route for staff, stretchers and trolley access.
- [] Separate the welcome queue from people walking onto the floor.

04 PLACE TURF, SLEDS AND FUNCTIONAL ZONES

- [] Turf and sled lanes need a long, unbroken run. Never cut them across the main aisle.
- [] Keep throw / slam / battle-rope work inside the functional bay, not in the spine.
- [] Anchor sleds and wall-balls where they cannot clip a passer-by.
- [] If the lane is shared with stretching, timetable it. Layout cannot fix a clash you ignore.
- [] Store sleds, prowlers and bags off the run so the lane stays clear between sets.

05 SIGHTLINES AND TRAINER POSITIONS

- [] From the trainer desk you should see the free-weight floor and the studio door.
- [] Mirrors help coaching, but glare from west light can wipe a wall at 5pm. Test it.
- [] Unstaffed hours still need a camera or a sightline to the entry, not a maze of racks.
- [] Do not hide the stretcher path behind a solid bank of cardio.
- [] Place the water point where a coach can still see the floor.

06 PEAK-HOUR TESTING

- [] Walk the plan at the busiest hour you expect, not at 11am on a Tuesday.
- [] If two classes change over, the holding space cannot spill onto the spine.
- [] Count stations, not only square feet. A full floor can still be one programme short.
- [] Watch bag drop, towel bins and bottle fillers — they become bottlenecks first.
- [] If a route only works when the gym is empty, redraw it.

07 FLOORING AND ADJACENCY

- [] Change flooring with the zone so members read the plan with their feet.
- [] Heavy lifting wants shock and a stable plate; turf wants a different build-up.
- [] Keep wet-adjacent finishes off the free-weight floor.
- [] Put plate trees and dumbbells where they are used, not where they look neat on a moodboard.
- [] Freeze the layout before you order equipment. Clearances are cheaper on paper.

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